HEALTHCARE INTELLIGENCE · FROM PUBLIC SOURCES NO. 2

VIGILLINE DAILY

TUESDAY, 27 OCTOBER 2026 BENGALURU COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Merck and Kelun-Biotech ADC cuts risk of death by one-third in advanced endometrial cancer

The Phase 3 result, reported by STAT News during the ESMO congress in Madrid, is a mortality benefit of the size that a regulatory submission can rest on.

A Phase 3 trial of an antibody-drug conjugate developed by Merck and China's Kelun-Biotech cut the risk of death by one-third in patients with advanced endometrial cancer, STAT News reported on Monday. The report appeared during the European Society for Medical Oncology congress in Madrid, where the week's late-stage oncology data have been presented.

What makes the figure consequential is where it sits in the evidence hierarchy. Risk of death is the endpoint regulators and health-technology assessors weight most heavily, and a reduction of one-third is large enough that the trial's design becomes the first question a competitive assessment has to answer: the comparator, the line of therapy and any biomarker selection all change the reading of the same number.

For a reader tracking endometrial cancer, the placement question is the commercial one. A survival benefit in first-line disease addresses a far larger population than one in the relapsed setting, and the two support different pricing and access arguments. The material reviewed does not specify the line of treatment, the comparator arm or the number of patients enrolled.

What follows is the filing. The material carries no submission date, no regulatory designation and no absolute survival figures, and VigilLine is not reporting numbers it cannot attribute. The presentation and any subsequent submission will settle whether the one-third describes an all-comer population or something narrower, and that answer decides how much of the indication the drug can address.

IN NUMBERS

one-third

reduction in risk of death, Phase 3 advanced endometrial cancer trial of the Merck and Kelun-Biotech antibody-drug conjugate

41%

of women with abnormal breast screening results who reached a diagnostic facility, 639 of about 1,557, KGMU study

2027

expected year of Merck and Moderna's FDA submission for their personalised cancer vaccine, per Moderna's chief executive

ALSO TODAY

SystImmune/BMS and Hengrui detail data in EGFR-mutant lung cancer
ENDPOINTS NEWS

GSK sees its return to cancer start to pay off
STAT NEWS

Beyond the cancer vaccine, how did Merck's oncology pipeline do at ESMO?
ENDPOINTS NEWS

BRIEFS

Roche pushes back its European filing for giredestrant as US pricing pressure bites

Roche will seek European approval for giredestrant later than it once expected, Endpoints News reported, using the shift to show how US drug-pricing pressure may be affecting launch strategies outside the US. The material reviewed does not give either date.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

BioNTech and DualityBio weigh next steps after a 'modest' Phase 3 for their HER2 ADC

Trastuzumab pamirtecan produced a "statistically significant, yet modest" Phase 3 result in certain breast cancer patients, BioNTech and DualityBio said, and the partners are weighing next steps. The material reviewed does not carry the effect size or the population.

ENDPOINTS NEWS

Merck and Moderna target a 2027 FDA submission for their cancer vaccine

Merck and Moderna are racing to submit their personalised cancer vaccine for FDA approval, with a filing expected in 2027, Moderna chief executive Stéphane Bancel said in comments carried by STAT. It is the first filing timeline attached to the readout.

STAT NEWS

Bon Secours Mercy Health to buy a surgery centre chain for $5.7 billion

Bon Secours Mercy Health agreed to buy a surgery centre chain for $5.7 billion, a deal STAT reports would make the Catholic nonprofit one of the largest operators of outpatient surgery centres. The transaction concentrates outpatient surgical capacity in a single system.

STAT NEWS

One death in Bristol Myers Squibb's early CAR-T trial in autoimmune disease

One patient died after receiving Bristol Myers Squibb's investigational CAR-T therapy in an early trial in autoimmune disease, the company reported. The death is a safety signal for a modality being tested outside oncology.

STAT NEWS

Only 41% of women with abnormal breast screening in a KGMU study reached a diagnostic centre

Of 51,894 women screened in a KGMU surgical oncology study, about 1,557 had abnormal breast examination results, but only around 639 (41%) reached a diagnostic facility. Hospital experts said half of women in Uttar Pradesh are first tested when breast cancer is advanced.

ET HEALTHWORLD

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